

KISHOR GORADE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Security Operations Engineer with 3+ years of experience across 24x7 SOC monitoring, incident response, and threat hunting in enterprise environments. Skilled in leveraging Elastic SIEM, Qualys EDR, Qualys VMDR, and Azure O365 to detect, investigate, and remediate security incidents across endpoint, network, cloud, and email attack surfaces. Proven ability to correlate multi-source log data, validate Indicators of Compromise (IOCs), and apply the MITRE ATT&CK framework to uncover adversary TTPs. Experienced in building Python-based automation and supporting SOAR and UEBA initiatives to reduce false positives, accelerate investigation turnaround, and strengthen overall detection engineering. Recognized for cross-functional collaboration with CSIRT and security engineering teams, driving continuous improvement in SOC processes, incident documentation, and blue team operations.

CORE COMPETENCIES

SOC Monitoring & Incident Response • Threat Hunting & Threat Intelligence • SIEM Engineering (Elastic, Splunk, QRadar) • EDR/XDR Operations (Qualys, CrowdStrike) • Log Correlation & IOC Analysis • Malware & Phishing Investigation • Detection Engineering & Alert Tuning • SOAR Automation & UEBA • Cloud Security (Azure O365) • Email Security (Proofpoint TAP) • Python & PowerShell Automation • MITRE ATT&CK & Cyber Kill Chain • Root Cause Analysis & Documentation • Vulnerability Management (Qualys VMDR) • Cross-Functional & CSIRT Collaboration

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Monitoring & SIEM: Elastic SIEM, Splunk, QRadar, Microsoft Sentinel, Alert Triage, Use Case & Rule Optimization

EDR / XDR & Endpoint Security: Qualys EDR, CrowdStrike, Endpoint Investigation, Windows Security, Linux Security

Threat Intelligence & Threat Hunting: MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, IOC/IOA Analysis, VirusTotal, AnyRun, Threat Intelligence Platforms

Cloud & Email Security: Azure O365, OCI, AWS, GCP, Proofpoint TAP, Phishing & BEC Investigation, Email Gateway Analysis

Automation & Programming: Python, PowerShell, SOAR Playbook Support, Automation Scripting

Vulnerability & Detection Engineering: Qualys VMDR, Detection Tuning, False Positive Reduction, UEBA

Security Frameworks & Compliance: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST IR Framework, Root Cause Analysis

Documentation & Ticketing: ServiceNow, OS Ticket, Incident Reporting, SOPs & Playbooks

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Security Operations Engineer — Qualys

January 2026 – Present

- Monitored security alerts across SIEM, EDR, and cloud platforms on a 24x7 basis, ensuring rapid identification and triage of emerging threats within SLA timelines.
- Investigated and remediated security incidents spanning endpoint, network, email, and cloud environments, minimizing dwell time and reducing business impact.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework to surface adversary TTPs and previously undetected malicious activity.
- Correlated log data across Elastic SIEM, Qualys EDR, Azure O365, and Proofpoint TAP to strengthen detection accuracy and eliminate visibility gaps.
- Analyzed Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) and performed malware investigations using VirusTotal and AnyRun, validating and containing active threats.
- Investigated suspicious Azure O365 activity and email-borne threats via Proofpoint TAP, mitigating phishing and business email compromise risk.
- Supported Qualys VMDR vulnerability management initiatives alongside Qualys EDR endpoint monitoring to reduce enterprise attack surface.
- Partnered with CSIRT and cross-functional security teams on incident containment, root cause analysis, and remediation planning.
- Drove detection tuning and false-positive reduction efforts, supporting SOAR playbook automation to improve alerting accuracy, response speed, and incident documentation.

Jr. SOC Analyst — AARNA Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

July 2023 – December 2025

- Monitored and triaged security alerts across Splunk SIEM and EDR platform CrowdStrike enabling rapid identification of and response to emerging threats.
- Investigated and resolved alerts through in-depth log analysis, malware investigation, and network traffic review to determine incident scope and impact.
- Partnered with CSIRT and IT infrastructure teams to drive incident containment, eradication, and recovery across enterprise environments.
- Conducted threat hunting initiatives to uncover Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) through cross-source correlation and behavioral analysis.
- Integrated threat intelligence feeds, including Recorded Future and VirusTotal, into SOC workflows to strengthen detection of evolving adversary TTPs.
- Optimized security infrastructure — firewalls, IDS/IPS, web proxies, and endpoint protection — to reduce exposure and improve detection efficacy.
- Authored and maintained incident response playbooks, SOPs, and security policies to standardize SOC operations.
- Led post-incident reviews, documenting root causes and corrective actions to prevent recurrence and strengthen organizational resilience.
- Automated repetitive SOC tasks using Python and PowerShell scripts, improving analyst productivity and operational efficiency.

PROFESSIONAL PROJECTS

Vigilance — Internal Threat Intelligence Aggregation Platform

- Collaborated with the security engineering team to design and build Vigilance, consolidating multiple threat intelligence feeds into one centralized dashboard, including requirements gathering and indicator validation.
- Impact: Reduced analyst manual effort, improved investigation speed, and delivered centralized threat intelligence visibility across the SOC.

SOAR Automation — Security Orchestration & Response Workflows

- Supported design, testing, and validation of SOAR automation playbooks with the Security Operations team to improve incident enrichment and response execution.
- Impact: Accelerated incident response times and reduced manual analyst workload through reliable, repeatable automation.

Alert Fine Tuning — SIEM Detection Optimization

- Partnered with senior Security Engineers to fine-tune recurring SIEM alerts through false positive analysis, rule optimization, and alert correlation.
- Impact: Reduced false positives, improved analyst efficiency, and elevated overall detection quality across the SOC.

Python Automation — SOC Tooling & Efficiency

- Developed Python automation utilities — including an IOC Validator, Threat Intelligence Lookup tool, Log Parsing Automation, and Investigation Helper Scripts — to eliminate repetitive SOC tasks.
- Impact: Reduced manual effort, improved investigation turnaround time, and increased overall SOC operational efficiency.

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Computer Science — Modern College, Ganeshkhind, Pune (CGPA: 8.37)
- Higher Secondary Certificate (HSC) — Vijaymala Junior College of Science, Shirur (73.83%)
- Secondary School Certificate (SSC) — Rasiklal Manikchand Dhariwal English Medium School, Shirur (83.40%)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Executive Vulnerability Management
- Incident Response Lifecycle
- Enterprise Security Leadership: Creating a World-Class SOC
- Cisco Endpoint Security Essentials

TECHNICAL TOOLS

Elastic SIEM, Splunk, QRadar, Qualys EDR, Qualys VMDR, CrowdStrike, Azure O365, Proofpoint TAP, VirusTotal, AnyRun, MITRE ATT&CK, Threat Intelligence Platforms, SOAR, UEBA, Python, PowerShell, ServiceNow, OS Ticket, Jira, Windows, Linux